WORKSHEET 1 OF 7

The Five Gates Card

One page. Copy it and keep it by the screen. It comes from chapter 3, "The Five Gates". Ten minutes a building, about two minutes a gate.

Building: _____ **Parcel no.:** _____ **Date:** _____

Min. 0–2 **1. Power**	Can the utility deliver enough electricity to this address, and when?		
Open this	**Record this**	**Stop when**	**Who gives the real answer**
Aerial, street view, property record	Visible equipment, past use, serving utility	The service is gone and the utility offers no path, or the building never had heavy power and you have better candidates	The serving utility, in writing. An electrical engineer for the equipment

Min. 2–4 **2. Permits**	Is this use allowed here, and what approvals stand in the way?		
Zoning map and code, FEMA flood map	District, exact words of the closest listed use, flood designation, nearest homes	The zoning plainly does not fit and the parcel sits among homes	Planning staff and the building official. A land use attorney for hard cases

Min. 4–6 **3. Structure**	Can the floor, the roof and the doors take the equipment?		
Property record, listing, aerial	Floor type, stories, docks, clear height if shown	Be slow to stop. Upper floors only: move it down the list	A licensed structural engineer

Min. 6–8 **4. Cooling**	Is there room outside to get rid of the heat?		
Aerial	Yard size, pipe route, roof, room for generators	No usable yard and no usable roof: move it down the list	A licensed mechanical engineer

Min. 8–10 **5. Connectivity**	Does enough fiber reach the building, by more than one route?		
FCC map, street view	Reported providers, markers and handholes	Almost never from a desk	The carriers, through a fiber survey

For each gate, write one line in three parts.

1. What I know, and where I got it.
2. What I do not know.
3. Who can tell me.

Then give the building one of two results.

- **Stop.** There is a clear, documented reason this building is a poor candidate today.
- **Go and see it.** Nothing stopped you. Call the owner and ask for twenty minutes and one electric bill.

"Unknown" is a status on a gate, not a result. Three unknowns and no stop is a good reason to make the call. Do not turn the page into a count. One fatal problem can end a project. Several fixable ones need not.

Before the gates, ask which megawatt. IT load is what the computers use. Facility load is everything the site draws at the meter. Chapter 2 shows how far apart they are.

Three sentences to keep apart, always.

- "The building has a 4,000 amp service." That is a nameplate.
- "A bill from a production year shows a past peak of so many kilowatts." That is history.
- "The utility has not yet confirmed capacity." That stays true until the utility writes otherwise.

Nothing on this page claims capacity, approval or a pass.